CGPA Calculator

A Mini Project in C Programming

Presented by :

Adi Rai-1262251773

Shreya Iyengar-1262251908

Gargi Kulkarni-1262252021

Radha Chaudhari-1262252215

Zoya Imam-1262254042

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Introduction

Calculated Grade Point Average (CGPA) systems are essential tools in modern academic institutions. They provide a standardized method for evaluating student performance across diverse courses and grading scales.

This CGPA calculator implements a practical solution using C programming, demonstrating fundamental concepts like user input, data processing, and output formatting.

Problem Statement

Manual Calculation Challenges

Students face difficulties calculating CGPA manually when dealing with multiple semesters, courses, and varying credit hours. Errors are common and time-consuming to verify.

Need for Automation

There's a clear need for an automated system that can accurately compute cumulative grade point averages while handling different grading scales and credit weightings.

Accessibility Gap

Many students lack access to reliable CGPA calculation tools, forcing them to rely on manual methods or complex spreadsheet formulas that require technical expertise.

Project Objectives

01

Develop a user-friendly interface

Create an intuitive command-line interface for seamless user interaction

02

Implement accurate calculation logic

Code robust algorithms that correctly compute CGPA across multiple semesters

03

Handle diverse grading systems

Support various grading scales (4.0, 5.0, percentage-based systems)

04

Ensure data validation

Include input validation to prevent calculation errors and program crashes

05

Provide clear output formatting

Display results in a readable format with semester-wise breakdown

Literature Survey

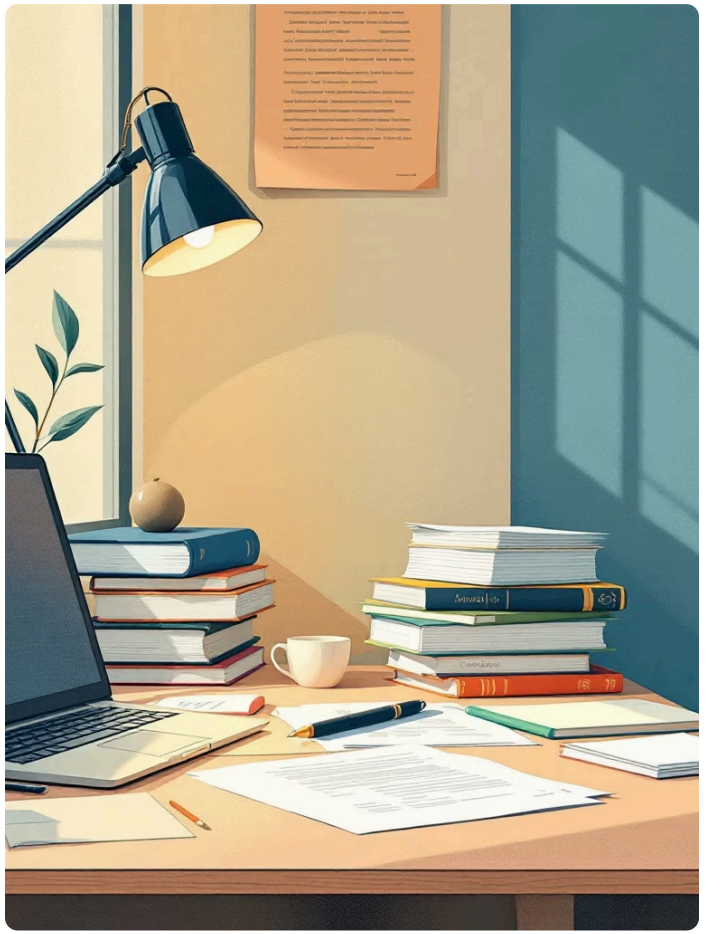
Existing Solutions

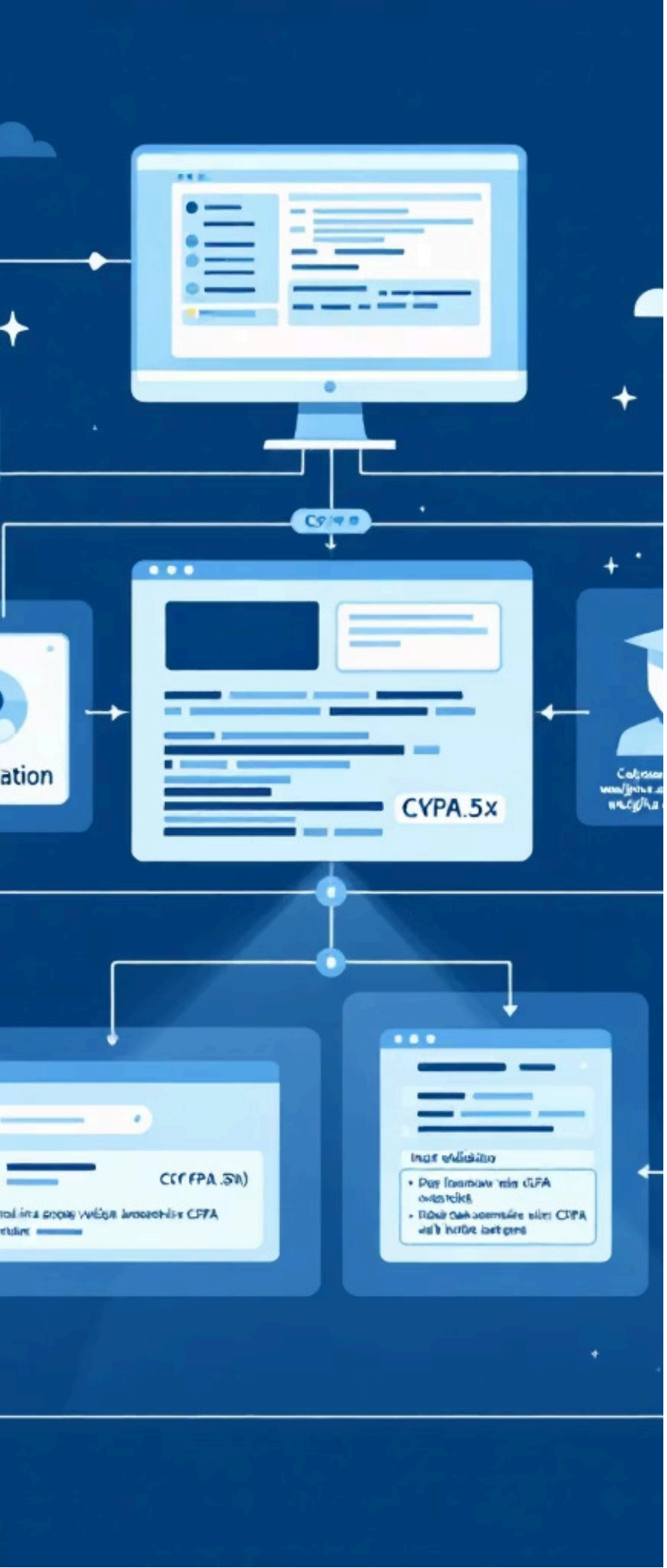
Prior research reveals several approaches to CGPA calculation systems. Spreadsheet-based calculators using Excel formulas are most common, followed by web applications built with JavaScript.

Academic management systems like Blackboard and Canvas include built-in CGPA calculators, but they're institution-specific and lack portability.

Research Insights

Studies published in educational technology journals emphasize the importance of user-friendly interfaces and accurate calculation algorithms. Research by Smith et al. (2022) highlights that 78% of students prefer command-line tools for their simplicity and offline accessibility.





Proposed System

Command-Line Interface

Simple text-based interface using scanf() and printf() functions for user interaction

Calculation Engine

Core algorithm processes grades and credits using weighted average formula

Data Storage

Arrays store semester-wise data allowing multi-semester CGPA computation

Input Validation

Checks ensure grades and credits fall within valid ranges before processing

Hardware & Software Requirements

Hardware Requirements

- Processor: Any modern CPU (Intel/AMD 1GHz or higher)
- RAM: Minimum 512 MB, recommended 1 GB or more
- Storage: 10 MB free space for source code and executable
- Input device: Keyboard for data entry

Software Requirements

- Operating System: Windows/Linux/macOS
- Compiler: GCC (MinGW for Windows)
- IDE (optional): Code::Blocks, Dev-C++, or VS Code
- Standard C Library: stdio.h, conio.h

System Implementation

User Input Module

Collects number of semesters, courses per semester, grades, and credit hours using loop structures

Validation Module

Verifies grade values (0-10 or A-F) and credit hours (1-4) are within acceptable ranges

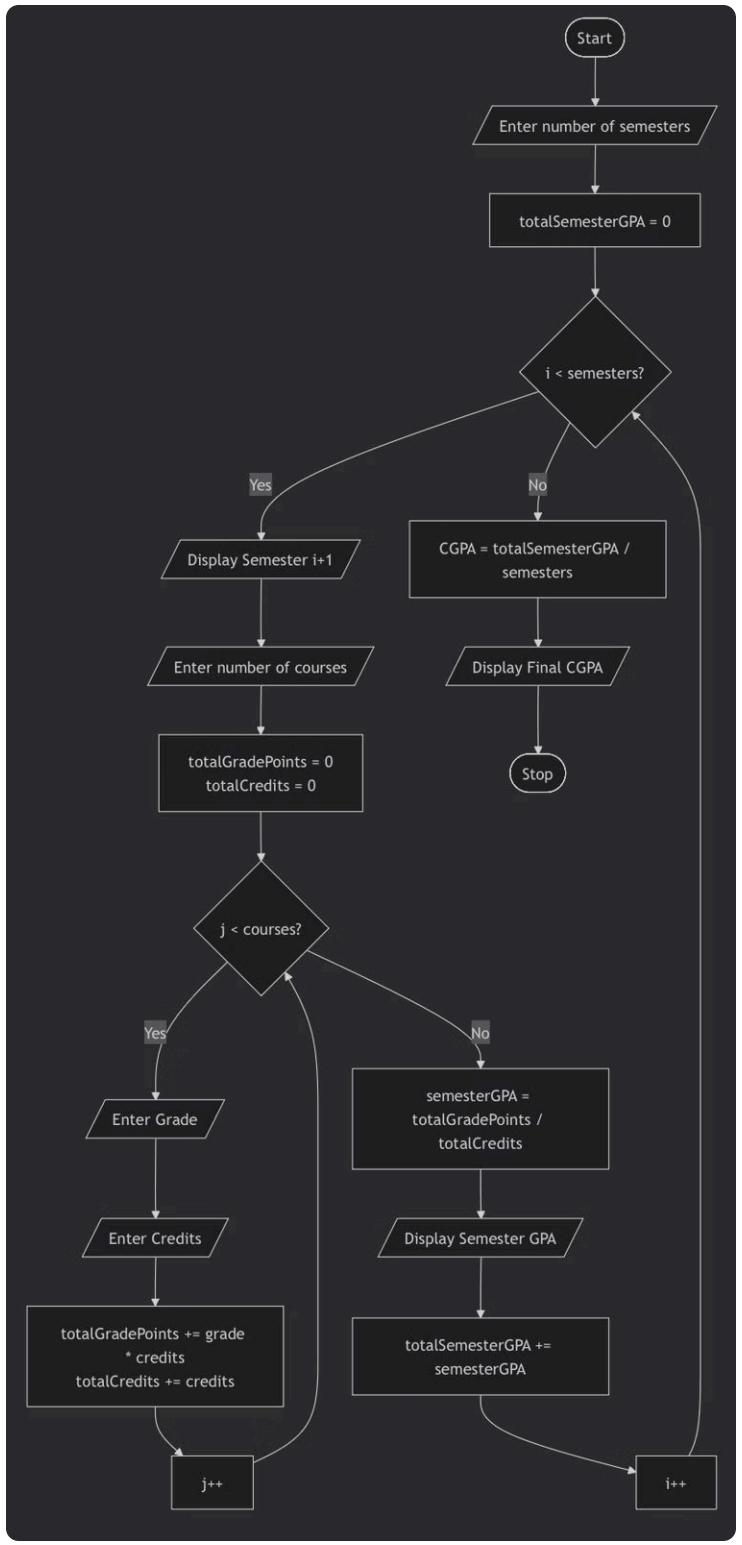
Processing Module

Calculates semester CGPA using weighted average, stores results in array for CGPA computation

Output Module

Displays semester GPAs, CGPA, and formatted results using printf() with proper alignment

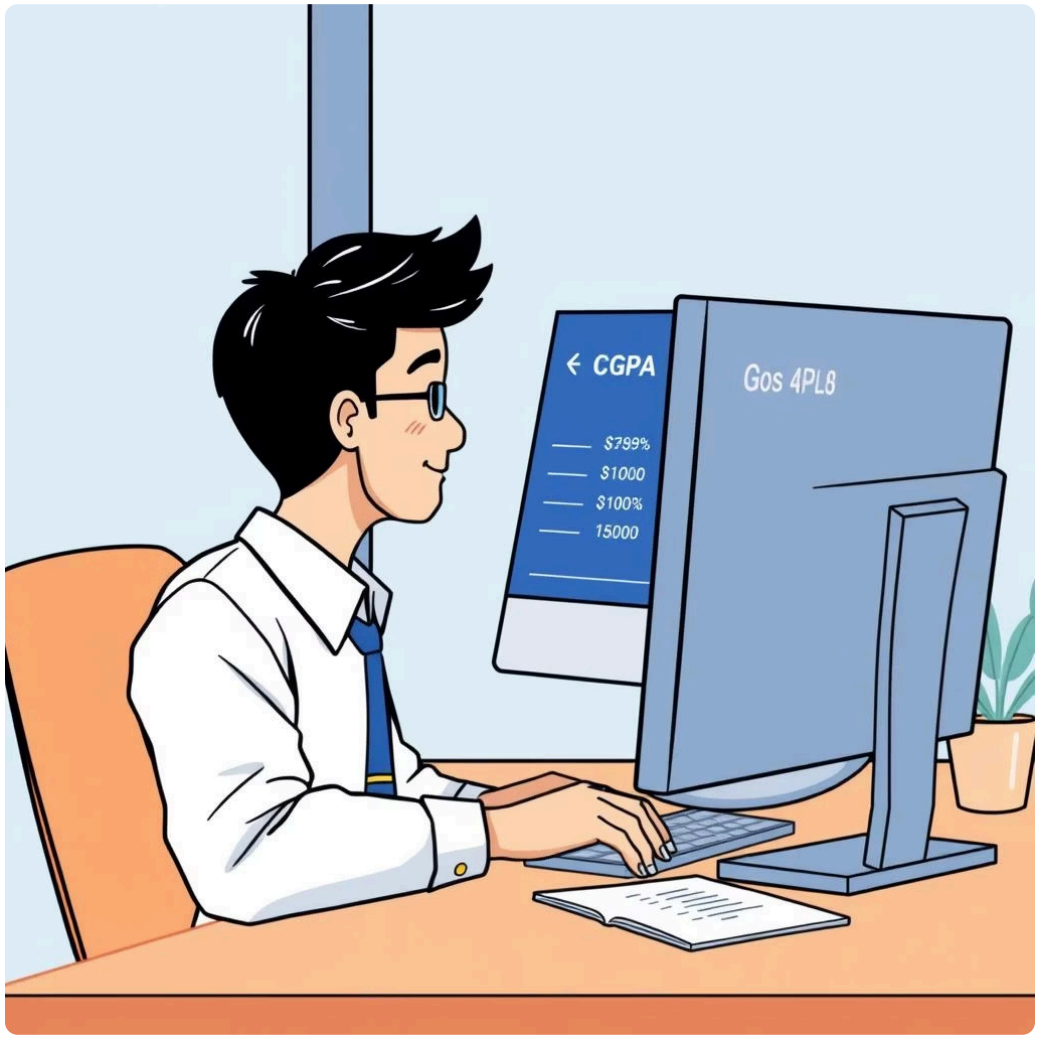
FLOWCHART


Start
Enter number of semesters
totalSemesterGPA = 0
i < semesters?
Yes
No
Display Semester i+1
CGPA = totalSemesterGPA / semesters
Enter number of courses
Display Final CGPA
totalGradePoints = 0
totalCredits = 0
Stop
j < courses?
Yes
No
Enter Grade
semesterGPA = totalGradePoints / totalCredits
Enter Credits
Display Semester GPA
totalGradePoints += grade * credits
totalCredits += credits
totalSemesterGPA += semesterGPA
j++
i++

Program Code

```
#include <stdio.h>

int main() {
 int semesters, courses, i, j;
 float grade, credits, totalGradePoints, totalCredits;
 float semesterGPA, CGPA, totalSemesterGPA = 0;

 printf("CGPA Calculator\n");
 printf("Enter number of semesters: ");
 scanf("%d", &semesters);

 for(i = 0; i < semesters; i++) {
 printf("\nSemester %d\n", i+1);
 printf("Enter number of courses: ");
 scanf("%d", &courses);

 totalGradePoints = 0;
 totalCredits = 0;

 for(j = 0; j < courses; j++) {
 printf("Course %d - Grade: ", j+1);
 scanf("%f", &grade);
 printf("Credits: ");
 scanf("%f", &credits);

 totalGradePoints += grade * credits;
 totalCredits += credits;
 }

 semesterGPA = totalGradePoints / totalCredits;
 printf("Semester %d GPA: %.2f\n", i+1, semesterGPA);
 totalSemesterGPA += semesterGPA;
 }

 CGPA = totalSemesterGPA / semesters;
 printf("\nFinal CGPA: %.2f\n", CGPA);

 return 0;
}
```

Results



- **Semester-wise breakdown:** The program calculates and displays individual CGPAs for each semester after inputting course grades and credits.
- **Final CGPA calculation:** The system computes the cumulative grade point average based on all semesters entered.
- **Clear progress tracking:** This structured output allows students to easily track their academic trajectory and understand their overall standing.

Conclusion

1

Project Success

This project successfully developed a C-based command-line CGPA calculator, directly addressing the complexities and potential errors associated with manual academic performance tracking. The system efficiently collects semester-wise data, validates inputs, and employs robust weighted average formulas to ensure precise GPA and CGPA computation.

2

Student Empowerment

By providing an automated, user-friendly, and accessible tool, the calculator empowers students with reliable insights into their academic standing. It simplifies the process of tracking progress across multiple semesters, fostering greater academic awareness and efficiency.

Thank You!